

Figure 1.11 *Robat Sharaf, second, inner courtyard. © Photograph Alka Patel 2011.*



Figure 1.12 *Robat Sharaf, oratory. © Photograph Alka Patel 2011.*

the Ghazna *minar*s were originally two-storied, with a bottom stellate shaft supporting a tapering cylinder on top (cf. Figure I.20). Given the rarity of stellate *minar*s in the region – *comparanda* known only in Sistan (cf. Chapter 2) – the Ghazna examples have incited debate as to their precedents and/or inspirations.

The Yamini precinct of Ghazna lies within distant but visible view of the composite Buddhist–Brahmanical Hindu site of Tepe Sardar (fl.